A-A-318A
September 14, 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-318
February 26, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
CHALK, MARKING, WHITE (EXTRUDED)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Federal Specification SS-C-266 which has been cancelled.

This commercial item description covers extruded (dustless) white marking chalk.

1. Salient Characteristics

The chalk shall be a minimum of 85 percent $CaCO_3$.

The chalk shall produce distinct, uniform and erasable markings when used for writing on commercial chalkboards.

A recognized seal shall be marked on the packaging certifying that the chalk does not contain toxic materials in quantities sufficient to be harmful to the user as a result of any reasonably foreseeable handling or use, including ingestion.

The chalk shall meet the requirements stated in Section 2.

Workmanship. The chalk shall have a smooth, uniform surface, with a soft velvety texture, and shall be composed of material that is free from any defect that may affect its performance or use.

2. Tables

Physical Characteristics	Requirement
Breaking Strength	5 pounds
Cross-sectional shape	circular, hexagonal or square
Length (minimum)	3-1/8 inches
*Cross-sectional width	3/8 ± 1/16 inch

* This width shall be constant throughout the chalk length.

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Breaking Strength Test. Place one piece of chalk across two horizontal parallel rods 1/4 inch in diameter and 2-1/2 inches apart. Using a 1/4 inch diameter rod, the test load shall be applied in a vertical direction at the midpoint of the chalk. Gradually apply and increase test load up to 3 pounds and maintain maximum load for 30 seconds. The chalk shall be of sufficient hardness to withstand the breaking strength test without breaking.

3. Quality Assurance

Each lot of chalk shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans specified below.

Sampling for visual examination - Inspection Level S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one piece of chalk.

Sampling for end item testing - Inspection Level S-2 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one piece of chalk.

Packaging, Packing, and Marking - Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container.

4. Preparation for delivery

Packaging, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

5. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein:

The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall be apply.

MIL-STD-105 is available from Naval Publications and Forms Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19120.

6. Recovered materials

The manufacturer shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

DOD has waived coordination interest.

Preparing Activity:

GSA/FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:07Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.